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**The Newsletter of the Friends of
Telford Town Park**

Spring 2011



Arena to be saved

You may remember from our last newsletter that the Friends of Telford Town Park have been campaigning for The Arena to be awarded Village green status to permanently protect it from inappropriate development. We are proud to announce that the Arena's long term future has now been protected by Telford & Wrekin Council's decision to place it as a "Field in Trust". It will become known as "The Queen Elizabeth 2 Telford Town Park Arena", to mark the Queens Diamond Jubilee next year. The decision by the council's cabinet was unanimous.

The protection will be very similar to that awarded by Village Green status. No buildings or structures can be erected on the space, nor can it be sold without the express approval of the Fields in Trust organisation. Even if that permission was given, the owners would have to provide an alternative site nearby. In the case of the Arena, this is unlikely, so the friends feel that the Arena is at last now safe from any kind of development. The Fields in Trust organisation has not lost one field in over seventy years, an impressive track record which bodes well for the Arena. More use will be made of the Arena and subject to a maximum of 9 chargeable events per annum, any profit ensuing is to be ploughed back into the Town Park.

The friends have worked very hard for the last 5 years to see this come to fruition at last and we hope many more people will use the enviable space that Telford Town Park offers its visitors. A big thank you to all who helped this come about, not just the Friends but people who signed forms for us and of course Telford & Wrekin Council for supporting it.



Landmark Eco Building Announced



The plans for the visitor centre to replace Spout Farm House have been unveiled and it will be one of the most energy efficient public buildings in the UK. In fact it will

be one of only a handful of such buildings to achieve the PassivHaus standard, one of the most energy efficient construction techniques in the world. Such buildings are designed to use almost no energy for heating and cooling, yet are comfortable all year round. The new visitor centre therefore has the potential to be a landmark project for the Park and the town.

Working for wildlife

With all the changes happening around the Southwater development, there's inevitably been less public attention on the quieter areas of the Park, but the Friends have been working to ensure its heritage and habitats don't get left behind. We recently teamed up with Telford & Wrekin Council and the Shropshire Bat Conservation Group to produce and install over 20 bat and bird boxes. This was needed to minimise the disruption to wildlife caused by the redevelopment. We had to seek professional advice on where to site them - we don't want Blue Tits using the bat boxes!



As usual we will also be running two of our Bat Walks this year in conjunction with the Shropshire Bat Group and Telford & Wrekin Council on Friday 20th May and Tuesday 9th August. These start at 8:45pm at the Norman Chapel. The walks are free and anyone is welcome. In previous years these have proved very popular so advance booking is essential. Please phone 01952 382340.

Spring Updates

In our last newsletter we featured the Crannog at Grange Pool. Recently the Friends gave it a spring clean, and we are now pleased to report that the living willow hide there has sprung into life. This is good news for bird lovers as the hide offers great views over the lake where herons, mallards, coots, moorhen, reed warblers, robins, blackbirds, jays, thrushes, and tree creepers are all fairly common sights. Please let us know if you see anything more unusual there.

The Friends have also been tidying up the Twin Tracks and the Queens Jubilee monument near Stirchley Chimney. There is still a lot of dense scrub to clear from this area which we want to maintain as open heathland. This is part of the long term habitat management for the town park, made possible by the lottery funding we helped to secure. We've also been working with the rangers planting hedges near Fletchers Pool to compensate for the loss of habitats at Southwater. We always welcome new volunteers to help with our work so please get in touch if you're interested.



Dates for your diary

Sat 23rd Apr St George's Day Fun 11am - 4pm, The Arena. **Free admission.**

Fri 20th May/Tues 9th August - Bat Walks. 8:45pm at the Norman Chapel.

Mon 2nd May/Sat 27th August - Heritage Walks. 12pm at the Norman Chapel.

These walks are free but please book in advance on 01952 382340

Sun 11th Dec - Telford's 5th Santa Fun Run from the new Visitor Centre.

Friends of Telford Town Park

We are a group of volunteers committed to protecting the Town Park, its natural and industrial heritage and promoting its enjoyment. All are welcome to join and membership is free..

We meet on the second Wednesday of each month at 6pm in Committee Room 3 of the Borough Council civic offices.

For more information call 01952 382340

Or visit our website www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org